



Samsung eMMC NAND Storage

Samsung has now started producing 128GB storage cards for tablets and smartphones announced at Samsung Mobile Solutions Forum 2012

Twitter Header Photo

Twitter rolls out a new option similar to Facebook which allows user to set a new header photo just like Facebook's Cover photo

Nikon D600

Full frame shooter for the budget photographer



Full frame cameras have been the fine line that divided amateurs/hobbyists from serious professionals for the longest time. Mostly, it was due to the fact that an amateur would have a hard time justifying the usually skyscraper-high price tag of a full frame. The professional, however, could easily shell out that kind of money, because the quality (and the work requirement) justified it.

However, there is a new movement underway, changing the landscape of photography and its requisite tools. A movement to put the prowess of a pro-grade camera into the hands of serious hobbyists (or professionals who are tight on funds). The new trend is marked by the Nikon D600, a "budget full-frame" DSLR from Nikon that was announced on September 13th.

Probably the worst kept secret in the history of pho-

tography product launches, the D600 packs in a sweet 24 megapixel full frame sensor. If you're a number junky, that's 2 whole megapixels more than Canon's 5D MarkIII and 3 more than the 5D MarkII, which can be had for about the same price as the D600, but it is an old camera in comparison.

The D600 seems to be some sort of mutant hybrid born out of D800 and D7000 interaction. The body follows a more D7000-like layout, but incorporates the ergonomic finesse of the D800. It has the same contoured curve for the thumb on the back along with the joystick/lock dial and the switch for video or photo mode in liveview. The D7000 DNA is evident when observing the button layout and the eye cup. Even the mode dial on the D600 is almost identical to the one on the D7000.

A key feature of the D600 full-frame DSLR is the focusing capabilities it packs inside. First off, it has a built in focus motor to maximize compatibility with the Nikon lens ecosystem. That is complimented by a Multi-CAM 4800 autofocus sensor module with 39-focus points, of which, 9 are cross type. The D800 has 51-focus points of which 15 are cross type. The camera has no problem acquiring focus in good light, high contrast light or even low light. Of course, the small number of cross type AF points limit the framing capabilities in low light, but that is made up by the fact that 7 of these AF points are sensitive up to f/8 when using with compatible NIKKOR lenses and teleconverters. Nature

and wildlife photographers are bound to love this, as far as prospective consumers of the camera are concerned.

The image quality of the D600 is typical full frame and signature Nikon. What we mean by that is that the sensor is able to capture a good amount of dynamic range along with rendering well saturated colors and a good contrast curve. The same can be said for the video, which is on par with the D800. One move on Nikon's part that we really appreciate is retaining the ability to stream uncompressed footage from the camera's HDMI port and into an external recorder. This is especially helpful for color grading footage and making adjustments.

All is not peachy in the Nikon camp though. We found that the D600 only takes SD cards, for which it has two slots. The lack of a CF card slot is a little bothersome especially if you're upgrading from a camera that only uses CF cards. We're also not so sure how we feel about the ₹1,35,950 price tag. While the rumours were running amok, word was that the price would be around \$1,800, or ₹90,000. With the D800 being priced only ₹35,000 more, we find it hard to not go for the 36 megapixel behemoth instead.

Regardless, the D600 is quite a significant move from Nikon, one that would definitely find many adopters due to its somewhat cheaper price tag, without compromising on any kind of performance one would expect from a camera of this league.

Swapnil Mathur

Specifications

Sensor: 24 megapixel full frame; **AF Points:** 39 with 9 cross type; **Burst Mode:** 5.5 frames per second; **Video:** 1920x1080 at 30, 25 and 24 fps

Contact

Nikon India Private Limited
Phone: 0124-4688500
Email: nindsales@nikon.co.in
Price: ₹1,35,950

8.0/10

Features8.0
 Performance.....8.0
 Build Quality8.5
 Value for Money7.5